

USAi Launch Release Notes

USAi is launching an updated production experience for Chat and Console. This release introduces new URLs, new models, expanded file upload support, improved web search, Markdown chat export, a refreshed Console experience, and platform-wide improvements to performance, accessibility, authentication, administration, and logging.

This release also begins the transition away from the legacy USAi Chat experience. Legacy Chat will remain available until **September 4, 2026**. Before that date, users should save or move any prompts and responses they want to keep from legacy.chat.agency.usai.gov.

These release notes summarize what is new, what has changed, which features have been removed or deprecated, and what may return in future releases based on user demand.

For feedback or questions, contact: partnerships@usai.gov

New URLs

Your agency will continue to access USAi at [agency].usai.gov, but the URLs that go *directly* to the Chat, Console, and API sections will be changing from chat.[agency].usai.gov to [agency].usai.gov/chat, [agency].usai.gov/console, etc.

Model Updates

The following new models are available in this release:

- Claude Sonnet 5
- Claude Opus 5
- Grok 4.3

The following models have been removed:

- Claude Opus 4.0
- Claude Haiku 3.5

Gemini 3.5 Flash is pending release upon additional security considerations.

Chat Updates

Major Updates

- **Improved document upload:** Files are now converted to Markdown for more accurate in-context processing, with added support for XLSX and CSV files.
- **Expanded file support:** Users can upload PDFs, Word documents, text files, spreadsheets, CSVs, and images, subject to the selected model's context window. Supported file types include XLSX, XLS, CSV, PNG, JPG/JPEG, and WebP. Drag and drop is also supported.
- **Improved web search:** Web Search now uses Google search summaries for faster responses and includes a new sources panel showing queries and visited sites. Banner language has also been updated for clarity.
- **Added tool support for USAi documentation:** Chat can now use supported tools to reference USAi documentation, including the USAi User Guide, when responding to user questions.
- **Updated chat export:** Markdown export is now available.
- **Enhanced conversation deletion:** Deleted chats are now removed from both chat history and S3, while required data retention controls remain in place.
- **Improved accessibility:** Chat includes accessibility improvements to support a more consistent and usable experience.
- **Improved response display:** Chat now includes better rendering for tables, LaTeX, code blocks, and inline code.

Additional Updates

- **Improved session timeout messaging:** Users now receive a clear banner notification when a session is approaching timeout.
- **Improved error handling:** Error messages have been refined to be clearer and more actionable.
- **Updated chat renaming:** Chat renaming now uses a dedicated modal instead of inline sidebar editing.
- **Moved the model selector:** The model selector has moved into the composer for easier access while chatting.
- **Improved chat history organization:** Chats are now organized by time range.

Deprecated Features

The following features are not present in the current release. Some are still under consideration for inclusion in future releases based on user demand.

Share your feedback at partnerships@usai.gov if you would like to see any of these features return.

Feature	Status
Edit AI response	Will not be released
Edit user prompt	Under review
Archive	Will be available in a future release
Duplicate	Will be available in a future release
Preview generated HTML	Under review
Thumbs up / thumbs down feedback buttons	Under review
Conversation timestamp	Under review
PDF exports	Under review
Previous responses under “Regenerate”	Under review
Prompt suggestion chips	Under review
Citation relevance score and content	Under review

Console Updates

Major Updates

- **Migrated API calls to the server side:** API calls now run server-side to improve security and reduce client-side complexity.
- **Unified the authentication flow:** Authentication is now more consistent across Chat, Console, and other USAi apps, making navigation faster and more seamless.

- **Migrated the Dashboard to the new architecture:** The existing Dashboard has been moved to the updated platform architecture. A more feature-rich Dashboard with additional insights is planned for a future release.
- **Created a Model Manager:** Agency administrators can now enable new models through self-service.
- **Created a Prompt Manager:** Agency administrators can now view the USAi platform system prompt and append agency-specific instructions.
- **Improved platform accessibility:** Accessibility improvements have been implemented throughout the application.
- **Improved application performance:** Page navigation and loading states have been improved to make the application feel faster and smoother.
- **Unified table design and behavior:** Tables now use reusable components, include built-in pagination, and have more consistent styling across the application.

Additional Updates

- **Updated API key creation:** On the API Key Management page, the **Create Key** button is now disabled until the user provides a key description.
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Under the Hood

- **Auth:** Migrated to Open Policy Agent, or OPA, for unified model authorization.
- **Backend:** Chat now runs on the standardized backend API.
- **Frontend:** Chat and Console now share a unified frontend.
- **Database:** Chat history moved from PostgreSQL to DynamoDB.
- **Configuration:** Added a new common configuration service to simplify management.
- **Logging:** Improved log shipping for large Chat and API requests, including support for raw and redacted S3 buckets.